

AI Chatbot Specification

■ Hair Salons / Spas

AI chatbot specification for hair salons, beauty studios, nail salons, and spa businesses in Singapore.

Suggested Pricing

Component	Price
One-time setup fee	\$400 - \$600
Monthly maintenance	\$80 - \$120/month
Add-on: WhatsApp integration	+\$150-200
Add-on: Payment collection	+\$100-150
Add-on: Custom integrations	+\$100-200 each

Business Pain Points (What You Sell Against)

These are the problems the business owner already knows they have. Lead with these in your pitch — don't sell 'AI', sell the solution to their pain.

- Missed calls during appointments = lost bookings. Stylists can't pick up the phone while cutting hair.
- Clients DM on Instagram asking about services and pricing — takes hours to reply.
- No-shows cost \$50-200 per missed appointment — no deposit system to discourage cancellations.
- Rescheduling requires back-and-forth: 'What times are available? How about Thursday? No, Friday?'
- New clients don't know which stylist to pick — no guidance on who specialises in what.
- Repeat bookings rely on clients remembering to call — no proactive re-booking reminder.

30-Second Sales Pitch

I'll build an AI booking assistant for your salon that takes appointments 24/7 on your website, WhatsApp, and Instagram. Clients book, reschedule, and ask about services without calling. It collects deposits to kill no-shows, and sends reminders automatically. You focus on cutting hair, the bot handles the admin.

Feature Requirements

Build in order: Must Have first (your MVP), then Should Have (first upsell), then Nice to Have (premium tier).

Feature	Description	Priority	Effort
Service & Pricing FAQ	Answer questions about services, pricing, duration, and what's included	Must Have	Low
Appointment Booking	Full booking flow: service, stylist preference, date/time selection	Must Have	Medium
Appointment Reminders	Automated WhatsApp/SMS reminders 24hr and 2hr before appointment	Must Have	Medium
Rescheduling & Cancellation	Clients can reschedule or cancel via chatbot with policy enforcement	Should Have	Medium
Deposit Collection	Collect deposit at booking to reduce no-shows	Should Have	Medium
Stylist Recommendation	Recommend a stylist based on service type and specialisation	Nice to Have	Low
Re-booking Reminder	Send reminder to rebook after typical service interval	Nice to Have	Medium

Detailed Feature Specifications

Use these specifications when building with Claude Code. Each feature includes the user story, technical implementation notes, and acceptance criteria.

Feature: Service & Pricing FAQ

Priority: Must Have | **Effort:** Low

User Story: As a client, I want to know how much a balayage costs and how long it takes before I book.

Technical Notes: Upload service menu with prices, duration, and descriptions. Handle price ranges ('balayage starts from \$180 depending on hair length'). Support queries about what services include.

Acceptance Criteria:

- Returns accurate price and duration for each service
- Handles hair-length price variations
- Explains what's included in each service
- Suggests add-ons: 'Would you also like a treatment?'

Feature: Appointment Booking

Priority: Must Have | **Effort:** Medium

User Story: As a client, I want to book a haircut with my preferred stylist at a time that works for me.

Technical Notes: Flow: select service(s) -> optional stylist preference -> show available slots from Google Calendar -> collect name + phone -> create booking. Handle multi-service appointments (haircut + colour = 3hrs). Buffer 15min between appointments.

Acceptance Criteria:

- Shows only actually available time slots
- Handles multi-service duration correctly
- Allows stylist preference or 'anyone available'
- Creates Google Calendar event with service details
- Sends confirmation with salon address

Feature: Appointment Reminders

Priority: Must Have | **Effort:** Medium

User Story: As a salon owner, I want clients to be reminded about their appointments to reduce no-shows.

Technical Notes: Scheduled job checks upcoming appointments. Send WhatsApp message 24hr before and 2hr before. Include: date, time, service, stylist, address. Option to confirm, reschedule, or cancel.

Acceptance Criteria:

- Sends reminder 24hr and 2hr before appointment
- Includes all appointment details

- Client can reply to confirm, reschedule, or cancel
- Cancelled/rescheduled slots freed for other bookings

Feature: Rescheduling & Cancellation

Priority: Should Have | **Effort:** Medium

User Story: As a client, I want to reschedule my appointment without calling the salon.

Technical Notes: Lookup existing booking by phone number. Show current appointment details. Allow reschedule (show new available slots) or cancel. Enforce cancellation policy (e.g., 24hr notice or lose deposit).

Acceptance Criteria:

- Finds booking by phone number
- Shows current booking details
- Offers available alternative slots for reschedule
- Enforces cancellation policy and explains deposit terms

Feature: Deposit Collection

Priority: Should Have | **Effort:** Medium

User Story: As a salon owner, I want to collect a deposit when clients book to reduce no-shows.

Technical Notes: After booking confirmation, generate PayNow QR or Stripe payment link for deposit amount (\$20-50 depending on service). Booking confirmed only after payment received. Deposit applied to final bill.

Acceptance Criteria:

- Generates payment link after booking is agreed
- Marks booking as 'pending' until deposit received
- Sends payment confirmation when deposit received
- Deposit amount based on service type

Feature: Stylist Recommendation

Priority: Nice to Have | **Effort:** Low

User Story: As a new client, I want help choosing a stylist who specialises in what I need.

Technical Notes: Store stylist profiles: name, specialisations, years of experience, available days. When client asks 'who does the best balayage', recommend based on specialisation match.

Acceptance Criteria:

- Recommends stylist based on service match
- Shows stylist's specialisation and experience
- Offers to book directly with recommended stylist

Feature: Re-booking Reminder

Priority: Nice to Have | **Effort:** Medium

User Story: As a salon owner, I want clients reminded to rebook 6-8 weeks after their last haircut.

Technical Notes: Track last visit date per client. Send WhatsApp reminder after configurable interval (e.g., 6 weeks for haircut, 4 weeks for nails). Include quick-book link.

Acceptance Criteria:

- Sends reminder at configured interval after last visit
- Includes one-tap booking link
- Respects opt-out preferences

Sample Conversations

These demonstrate expected chatbot behaviour. Use these as test cases during development.

Scenario: New client booking an appointment

Customer: I want to book a haircut and colour

Bot: Great! For haircut + colour, prices start from \$120 (depending on hair length and colour type). We have 3 stylists available. Do you have a preferred stylist, or would you like whoever is available soonest?

Customer: Whoever earliest

Bot: Sarah has a slot this Thursday 2pm. Haircut + colour will take about 2.5 hours, finishing around 4.30pm. Shall I book that?

Customer: Can, book

Bot: Booked! To confirm your appointment, I'll send you a PayNow link for a \$30 deposit (applied to your final bill). Can I get your name and phone number?

Scenario: Client rescheduling

Customer: I need to change my appointment

Bot: No problem! Can I have the phone number you booked under?

Customer: 9876 5432

Bot: Found it — you have a haircut with Sarah this Thursday 2pm. Would you like to reschedule or cancel?

Customer: Reschedule to Saturday

Bot: Sarah is available Saturday at 10am or 3pm. Which works better?

Technical Architecture

Core Stack (Required)

Component	Technology	Purpose
LLM	Claude API (claude-sonnet-4-20250514)	Understands questions and generates answers from context
Vector Database	ChromaDB (local) or Pinecone (cloud)	Stores document embeddings for RAG retrieval
Embedding Model	Voyage AI or OpenAI text-embedding-3-small	Converts text chunks to vectors
Backend	Python FastAPI	API server handling chat requests

Frontend Widget	Vanilla JS embeddable snippet	Chat bubble on client's website
Admin Dashboard	Streamlit or Next.js	Where business owner uploads docs and views analytics

Add-on Integrations

- **Google Calendar API:** Real-time availability, booking creation, stylist schedule management
- **WhatsApp Business API:** Booking confirmations, reminders, rescheduling — primary channel for SG clients
- **Instagram DM API:** Auto-reply to Instagram enquiries and booking requests
- **Stripe / PayNow:** Deposit collection at booking, payment processing
- **Telegram Bot:** Notify stylists of new bookings and cancellations

Data Model (Documents to Collect from Client)

These are the documents and data you need from the business owner during onboarding. The quality of these documents directly determines chatbot accuracy.

- **Service Menu:** All services: name, description, price (or price range by hair length), duration, add-ons
- **Stylist Profiles:** Name, specialisations, experience, working days/hours, photo (optional)
- **Operating Hours:** Salon hours, individual stylist schedules, public holiday closures
- **Booking & Cancellation Policy:** Deposit amount, cancellation notice period, no-show policy, rescheduling rules
- **Salon Info:** Address, Google Maps link, nearest MRT, parking, contact number

PDPA Compliance Checklist (Singapore)

- Display clear data collection notice before collecting any personal data
- Get explicit consent before storing name, phone, email
- Provide opt-out option: 'Type STOP to opt out of data collection'
- Do not store NRIC, credit card numbers, or medical records in chat logs
- Implement data retention policy: auto-delete chat logs after 90 days
- Provide data export/deletion on request from the business owner
- Add privacy policy link in the chat widget footer

Singapore Localisation Notes

- Support Singlish phrasing: 'got discount ah?', 'how much one?', 'can book or not'
- Handle mixed language queries (English + Mandarin terms are common)

- Use SGD (\$) for all pricing — never USD
- Time format: 12-hour with AM/PM (e.g., 3pm, not 15:00)
- Support PayNow QR code generation for payments
- Reference local landmarks for directions ('near Jurong East MRT')
- Public holiday awareness for Singapore calendar